

now a certainty, enterprises are in a scale-up mode and hiring in a big way. According to Deepak Kumar, market researcher and consultant in the information and communication technology sector, Gartner, this will necessitate a scale-up in PC purchases.

3G subscriber base to reach 200 million by 2013

By 2013, India is projected to have sold 395 million 3G handsets and clock a 3G subscriber base of about 200 million.

3G-capable handsets are priced at Rs 4000 to above Rs 30,000. Therefore the switching cost for handsets would vary from user to user, depending on needs and application preferences.

Abhishek Khanna, analyst, Evaluateserve, believes handset manufacturers will begin to focus on providing inexpensive 3G handsets to ensure that the demand for 3G handset increases among the youth—a key segment for pushing 3G data services.

WiMax to drive broadband growth

India has over 8.5 million broadband customers as of now and the copper line infrastructure is limited.

“So going wireless is the only option for India and the growth will come from wireless technologies like WiMax. The next few years will be big for WiMax and one would see huge growth in numbers,” said Lil Mohan, Intel managing director (WiMax programme office, APAC and META business development).

Mohan added that over the next three-four years, majority of broadband connections would be on the wireless platform. WiMax is designed to provide high-speed access to the Internet with much faster data downloads.

India second in mobile Internet usage

According to a recent report by Internet search giant Google, India comes second in mobile Internet usage, surpassed by only the US. The month of February 2010 saw 14 billion Web pag-

es on mobile phone screens, and India accounted for 5.9 per cent of that share. Though India still lags far behind the US in mobile data usage, it is ahead of China in this regard. Vinay Goel, product head, Google India, says that India's mobile Internet usage has shown a fivefold increase in the last five years.

Though high-end devices are the norm in the US and other western countries for Internet browsing, India still relies on low-end handsets to surf the Web. For instance, the most popular mobile phones for Web browsing in India are the Xpress Music 5130 and the 3110c, which are priced between Rs 3500 and Rs 5500. Nokia is the most preferred mobile Web browsing tool in India.

Handset makers eyeing Indian market

With the handset market in India estimated at Rs 500 billion, one new mobile vendor is entering the market every month. This has taken the total count of handset manufacturers to over 30 from a mere five in 2008.

Refuting the analysts' claims that touchscreen phones may bag a significant market share of the overall mobile phone market, Vineet Taneja, head of marketing, Nokia India, said, “Touch is just an input mechanism. It can never become 100 per cent of the market. It is in vogue now but that's about it.”

While Nokia currently dominates the mobile handset market with a share of 70 per cent, in the touchscreen space Samsung claims to lead the pack with a market share of 30 per cent.

MTNL launches 3G mobile TV service

Alcatel-Lucent, in collaboration with Aksh Optifibre, an IPTV service provider, has enabled the commercial launch of India's first 3G-driven mobile TV services.

The new mobile TV service, uniquely offered by the broadband mobile provider MTNL, makes multimedia and entertainment on mobile

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